Guitar Exercises - Section XIV, Level 97

Recording-Led Repertoire Reconstruction

Audio -> Form -> Harmony -> Groove -> Riffs -> Arrangement -> Performance

Level 97 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. HARD STOP after Level 105.

The chord chart is now removed. The student begins with audio and must build a playable, defensible guitar arrangement from evidence rather than from supplied notation.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Blind first-listen form and pulse map	96
B	Bass/root and harmonic reconstruction	144
C	Groove, note-length, and texture transcription	128
D	Signature riff/hook transcription	144
E	Structural-versus-incidental detail classification	96
F	Functional arrangement from incomplete audio evidence	128
G	Source comparison and divergence audit	112
H	Two 16-bar recording-led studies	192
I	Forty-eight-bar audio-to-performance capstone	320
J	Independent verification and mastery audit	64
	TOTAL	1424

Core rule: reconstruct function before detail; verify structure before ornament.

Reference - Seven-Pass Audio Reconstruction

Pass	Listen for	Do not solve yet
1	pulse/form	exact chords
2	bass/root motion	extensions
3	chord quality/function	voicing
4	groove/note length	lead fills
5	signature riffs/hooks	incidental variations
6	register/texture/dynamics	exact tone/effects
7	ending/cues/recovery landmarks	micro-details

One listening pass has one job. Repeatedly trying to solve everything at once wastes ear-training information.

Module A - Blind First Listen

Question	Allowed answer
Meter/pulse	4/4, 3/4, 6/8, uncertain
Tempo class	slow / medium / fast
Subdivision	straight / swing / shuffle / mixed
Section count	number only
Repeated section?	yes/no + approximate location
Largest dynamic change	section/time
Ending behavior	stop / sustain / fade / unresolved
Confidence	0 guess / 1 plausible / 2 confirmed

No guitar during Pass 1. Tap, count, and write only.

Module A - Form Map from Audio

Pass	Deliverable
1	neutral labels A/B/C
2	bar count per section
3	repeated/altered repeats
4	one landmark per section
5	transition cue
6	dynamic/texture level
7	memory recitation with audio stopped

Do not name Verse/Chorus until the musical role is clear. Neutral labels are valid.

Module B - Bass and Root Reconstruction

Stage	Task
1	sing lowest structural note at each chord change
2	find bass note on one string
3	write scale degree relative to likely tonic
4	distinguish root from inversion bass
5	play roots through full form
6	add fifths only if useful
7	verify cadence roots independently

If bass is unclear, identify cadence destinations first and work backward.

Module B - Harmonic Quality Reconstruction

Evidence	Likely question
Major/minor third audible	major or minor?
Flat seventh	dominant/minor7 function?
Major seventh	tonic color or voice-leading?
Flat fifth	half-diminished/diminished?
Suspended third	sus or omitted third?
Chromatic dominant third	secondary/applied dominant?
Bass differs from chord root	inversion/slash chord?

Build the simplest chord that explains the recording. Add extensions only when they affect identity or voice leading.

Module C - Groove Transcription

Layer	Write
Subdivision	eighth/sixteenth/triplet grid
Primary contacts	P attacks only
Note length	long/medium/clipped
Ghosts/mutes	only after P map is secure
Accents	strong landmarks
Bass/drum relationship	lock / answer / leave space
Section variation	what changes and what stays

First reproduce the groove on muted strings. If it does not resemble the source, chord accuracy will not rescue it.

Module C - Texture and Register

Evidence	Arrangement inference
Low guitar doubles bass	consider root/power role
Upper clipped chords	triad/shell comping
Wide sustained chord	open/spread voicing
Single-note repeated cell	riff/counterline role
Bass + upper note	hybrid/independent-voice texture
Guitar absent	intentional rest is part of arrangement
Texture changes at chorus	map register/density shift

Silence is transcribed as arrangement information.

Module D - Signature Riff/Hook Transcription

Pass	Task
1	sing/tap rhythm only
2	mark contour: up/down/same
3	find first structural pitch
4	derive remaining scale degrees
5	locate ergonomic fretboard route
6	match articulation only after notes/rhythm
7	transpose to one other key to prove understanding

A riff is structural when removing it makes the section materially less identifiable.

Module D - Fill Triage

Fill type	Treatment
Repeated identically	transcribe exactly
Signals section change	transcribe function and rhythm
One-time improvised fill	approximate or omit
Overlaps vocal	usually lower priority
Defines ending	transcribe exactly
Demonstrates chord inversion	preserve harmonic effect
Pure texture/noise	recreate only if performance needs it

Time spent transcribing should track structural importance, not difficulty.

Module E - Structural vs Incidental Classification

Detail	Structural test
Chord inversion	Does bass motion/function change?
Ghost note	Does groove identity collapse without it?
Extension	Does chord quality/voice-leading change?
Fill	Does it cue a section?
Articulation	Is phrase identity lost without it?
Tone/effect	Does arrangement function survive clean?
Register	Does moving it create masking or lose contrast?
Rest	Does filling it damage groove/phrase?

Label each discovered detail S = structural, C = color, O = optional. Build the first performance using S only.

Module F - Functional Arrangement Build

Version	Contains
Skeleton	form + roots + landmarks
Functional	correct chord qualities + groove
Identity	signature riff/hook + section textures
Performance	voicings + fills + expression
Reduced	50% fewer fills/ornaments
Emergency	roots/shells + landmarks only

All six versions must reach the ending without stopping.

Module F - Voicing from Audio Evidence

Source clue	First voicing test
Dense low guitar	power chord / low partial
Bright high chop	top-string triad
Warm middle support	shell / compact 7th
Open acoustic texture	open/spread chord
Fast harmonic rhythm	nearest inversions
Lead-heavy section	minimal shell
Unknown exact grip	functionally equivalent voicing

Exact fingering is lower priority than harmonic function, register, and groove unless the grip itself creates a signature sound.

Module G - Source Comparison Audit

Difference	Accept if...	Revise if...
Voicing differs	same function/register role	changes bass/function
Fill differs	nonstructural	cues section or hook
Tone differs	groove/role survive	tone is identity-defining
Rhythm simplified	pocket intact	signature rhythm lost
Extension omitted	quality clear	voice-leading changes
Register differs	no masking	section contrast lost
Ending differs	clear and intentional	source ending is required target

The goal is a defensible performance reconstruction, not forensic imitation of every transient.

Module G - Divergence Score

Score	Meaning
0	functionally wrong
1	different but plausible
2	matches structural behavior
3	matches structural behavior and important detail

Score form, bass, harmony, groove, signature material, texture, and ending separately. Prioritize any category scoring 0.

Module H - Study 1 - Groove-led audio brief

16 bars. No chart. Likely major key. One repeated two-beat guitar rhythm, one section change at bar 9, one ending figure.

Reconstruct form, roots, chord quality, signature rhythm, section texture, and ending.

Pass	Deliverable
1	blind form/pulse
2	bass/root map
3	harmony
4	groove
5	signature material
6	functional performance + audit

Module H - Study 2 - Harmony-led audio brief

16 bars. No chart. Contains one secondary dominant and one minor-key cadence. Guitar alternates comping and short lead answers.

Reconstruct harmonic function, guide-tone targets, role changes, one repeated answer, and ending.

Pass	Deliverable
1	blind form/pulse
2	bass/root map
3	harmony
4	groove
5	signature material
6	functional performance + audit

Module I - Forty-Eight-Bar Audio-to-Performance Capstone

Bars	Section	Input	Student task
1-4	Intro	audio only	identify pickup/texture
5-12	A	audio only	form + groove + harmony
13-16	B	audio only	contrast + cue
17-24	A'	audio only	variation vs original A
25-32	C	audio only	new harmonic/role behavior
33-40	Solo/support	audio only	separate structural targets from improvised detail
41-44	Return	audio only	recognize landmark
45-48	Outro	audio only	reconstruct ending/cutoff

Use an unfamiliar 48-bar recording or self/partner-created source. No chord chart. Produce: one-page form map, root/function chart, groove map, S/C/O detail classification, performance arrangement, reduced fallback, and one uninterrupted memory take.

Module J - Independent Verification and Mastery

Category	0	1	2
Form	wrong	mostly	secure
Bass/function	wrong	plausible	confirmed
Harmony	wrong	functional	clear
Groove	lost	approximate	source-like
Signature material	missing	partial	clear
Structural judgment	poor	mixed	disciplined
Performance	stops	functional	convincing
Recovery	restart	simplifies	seamless

Pass Level 97: 14/16 or better on two separate unfamiliar excerpts, with no zero in form, bass/function, groove, or recovery.

Next: Level 98 moves from reconstruction to adaptation: transposition, rearrangement for different ensemble roles, acoustic/electric conversion, simplification without identity loss, and alternate-version performance.